



Delaware County Council May 26th 2020

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=P9OEy5Llqeo
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Delaware County Council Meeting Summary

Meeting Date: May 2020 (Specific date derived from Memorial Day references in transcript)

Body: Delaware County Council

Format: Virtual Electronic Meeting (Zoom)

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

(No statutory public hearing or committee session was held immediately prior to calling the regular meeting to order.)

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding officer opened the meeting by leading an invocation/prayer and noting that the agenda was properly posted and advertised.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present (In-person/Online):** Mr. Bledsoe (President), Ms. Chambers, Ms. Lassiter, Ms. Piper, Mr. Quackenbush (Online), Mr. Alexander, Mr. Hughes, Mr. Ballard, Mr. Ryan.
 - **Absent:** None noted.
 - **Presiding Officer:** Mr. Bledsoe (Council President).

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** Opening prayer/invocation delivered referencing Memorial Day and frontline workers.
 - **Approval of Minutes:** Motion made and seconded to approve prior meeting minutes; approved via roll call vote.
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:03:17 Ordinance 2020-05: Balanced Holdings Incorporated (BHI) Bond Ordinance**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Brad Bookout (Economic Development), Peter Floria & Jacob Floria (Developers / BHI), Heather James (Bond Counsel, Ice Miller), Matt Agler (Financial Consultant, Baker Tilly).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Brad Bookout introduced an approximate \$2.0M<U+2013>\$2.2M bond issuance for Balanced Holdings Incorporated (BHI) / Assaya Technologies. BHI plans an \$18M investment in new buildings and equipment on 33 acres in Daleville, Indiana along I-69, featuring agricultural technology and manufacturing facilities. The bond is funded upfront by the developer and repaid exclusively from TIF revenue generated by the new buildings, with no taxpayer monies pledged or risked. Discussion ensued regarding local hiring priorities (100% priority given to Delaware County residents) and TIF district sunseting. Councilman Ron Hughes requested a stipulation/amendment to ensure the TIF district sunsets automatically upon bond maturity so that excess tax revenues return to the general tax base rather than remaining in a TIF allocation fund indefinitely.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None directly from the general public during this item, aside from developer and board presentations.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved for introduction (Passed Unanimously via roll call vote), with an agreement that bond/TIF documents will be amended prior to second reading to include a TIF sunset clause.
- **00:26:49 Treasurer<U+2019>s Report & Tax Collections Update**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Steve (County Auditor) & Tommy (Treasurer's Office).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The County Treasurer was absent due to a minor injury. Auditor Steve reported on property tax collections and advance draws, noting an approximate 12.5% to 13% reduction compared to previous years, which is comparatively favorable against surrounding counties. The tax collection deadline has been extended to July 10, after which a subsequent advance draw of \$4M<U+2013>\$5M will be distributed to local units.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Information received and filed.

- **00:29:25 Resolution 2020-015: Hiring Freeze Amendment**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** County Council & Legal Counsel Bill.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Discussion regarding an amendment to the county hiring freeze resolution to explicitly exempt grant-funded positions within Community Corrections.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved as amended (Passed Unanimously via roll call vote).
- **00:33:34 CARES Act / COVID-19 Reimbursement Tracking**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Auditor Steve.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Auditor Steve briefed the council on available federal COVID-19 reimbursement funds (~\$3.7M available for Delaware County). To prevent duplicate claims or errors across departments (such as EMS and the Commissioners), the auditor's office proposed centralizing all department expense tracking and filings through the County Auditor. Council discussed drafting a joint resolution between the Commissioners and the County Council authorizing the Auditor's office to manage filings.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Consensus to direct legal counsel to draft a joint resolution with the Commissioners.
- **00:39:12 Financial Transfers (Various Funds)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** County Auditor / Department Heads.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Review and processing of routine departmental budget transfers:
 - Council transfer (\$25,000) (Passed Unanimously via roll call vote).
 - Additional transfer items (Passed Unanimously via roll call vote).
 - Jail Public Safety transfer (\$20,296.40) (Passed Unanimously via roll call vote).
 - Community Corrections transfer (\$19,972.54) (Passed Unanimously via roll call vote).
 - Commissioners' transfer (Withdrawn).
 - EMS transfer (\$10,952.36) (Passed Unanimously via roll call vote).
 - Highway and Bridge FICA/Unemployment transfers (\$38,000 and \$15,000 related to furlough adjustments) (Passed Unanimously via roll call vote).
- **00:50:30 Committee Appointments & Reappointments**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Council President Scott Bledsoe.
 - **Deliberation Summary:**
 - **Economic Development Commission:** Nominated Jessica Piper. (Approved by Voice Vote / Roll Call).
 - **Yorktown Economic Development Commission:** Nominated Ryan Ballard. (Approved by Voice Vote / Roll Call).

- **Muncie Library Board:** Reappointed Billy Shepherd and Royce Mitchell to four-year terms beginning June 1, 2020. (Approved by Voice Vote / Roll Call).
- **Civic Center Authority:** Reappointed Marianne Kratochvil and Jessica Piper. (Approved by Voice Vote / Roll Call).

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

(No general public speakers or citizen forum turns occurred during this section of the meeting; public comment instructions were noted at the beginning directing inquiries to County Council digital channels.)

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - **Electronic Signatures:** Council conducted a roll call vote authorizing the use of electronic signatures on all documents approved during the meeting (Passed Unanimously).
 - **Budget Calendar:** Tentatively scheduled department head budget hearings for September 1st and 2nd, with budget adoption targeted for September 22nd.
 - **Local Updates:** Mention of local blood donation drives and positive news coverage regarding local businesses (Big-Time Barbell).
- **Adjournment:** Motion made by Ryan, seconded by Ron, to **recess** the meeting (Passed Unanimously via roll call vote).

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